Deliverable 5 — Admissions, Visa & Funding Master Timeline

Start date: 15 October 2026 · Target: arrive in Ireland around 25 August 2027 · Dates marked **(official)** come from a published source. All other dates are recommended operating targets that leave a safety buffer.

At a glance

Phase	Window	Outcome that closes the phase
0. Launch	15 – 31 Oct 2026	IELTS booked, documents ordered, referees briefed
1. Applications	Nov – Dec 2026	All four applications submitted by **15 Dec**; Galway and UL by **30 Nov**
2. Offers & scholarships	Jan – Mar 2027	Offers compared, one deposit paid, GOI-IES submitted
3. Funding	Mar – May 2027	Loan sanctioned and tuition paid; visa finance pack ready
4. Visa & housing	Late May – Jul 2027	Visa approved; accommodation contract signed
5. Departure & arrival	Aug – Oct 2027	Arrived, IRP card issued, bank account and PPSN in place

Phase 0 — Launch (15 – 31 October 2026)

By	Action	Detail / tactic
20 Oct	**Book IELTS Academic** (IDP or British Council, Bengaluru)	Test date in the **first half of November**. Target 7.0 overall, no band below 6.5; the minimum is 6.5 / 6.0. Results arrive in 3–5 days (computer-delivered), which leaves a retake slot in December if needed.
20 Oct	Order documents	Bangalore University (B.Com) and VTU/DSCE (MBA): **official transcripts for all semesters, degree certificates, and a CGPA-to-percentage conversion letter**. Allow 2–4 weeks.
22 Oct	Get the B.Com syllabus	Extract the Financial Accounting, Management Accounting and Business Finance syllabi, which Galway's Pathway A prerequisite requires.
25 Oct	**Brief three referees**	Send each one the CV, SOP and their draft letter from Deliverable 4. Confirm their **official email addresses**, because the portals will contact them directly.
25 Oct	Experience proof	EY relieving/experience letter, Amazon employment verification letter, recent payslips
28 Oct	Create portal accounts	Galway (open since 1 Oct), UL, DCU, Trinity Business School. Download the checklist for each one.
31 Oct	Register for **Education in Ireland** fair / webinars	Use the fair for **application-fee waiver codes** and to speak to the Galway, UL and DCU representatives. Use the email script in Deliverable 1 §6.
31 Oct	**Funding reality check with family**	Confirm the savings figure (assumed ₹5–8 L), possible co-applicant (parent with ITRs) and any collateral. This decides whether Dublin is realistic.

Phase 1 — Portal submissions (November – December 2026)

By	Action	Detail / tactic
10 Nov	Sit IELTS	Galway, UL and DCU accept "results pending" submissions, but an application with a score is stronger.

By	Action	Detail / tactic
15 Nov	Finalise SOP versions	Galway (primary), UL and DCU swap paragraphs, all from Deliverable 3. Have one external reader proofread.
20 Nov	**Submit University of Galway — MSc IAA (Pathway A)**	Rolling admissions, so early submission gets the earliest review and the best position for the 2027/28 Cairnes merit scholarships once announced. Upload the syllabus extract.
25 Nov	**Submit University of Limerick — MSc Insurance & Risk Management**	Ask the Kemmy Business School office in writing for the **2027/28 fee**.
30 Nov	**Submit DCU — MSc International Accounting & Business (DC526)**	The **€2,000 DCU award is assessed automatically**, so submit early while funds remain.
30 Nov	Watch the Galway Cairnes scholarship page	The 2027/28 business merit scholarship details are under review. Apply the day they are published.
15 Dec	**Submit Trinity — MSc OSCM** *(only if family funding ≥ ₹15 L above the loan is confirmed)*	Trinity Business School applications open in November and run in rounds; Round 1 is usually the best. Otherwise submit **DCU MSc Management — Operations & Supply Chain (DC537)** as the cheaper pivot.
Ongoing	Chase referees	Send a polite reminder 5 days after each portal request goes out.
Dec	Respond fast to queries	Universities may ask for course descriptions or a percentage conversion. Reply within 48 hours.
Dec	Start a **loan pre-assessment**	Talk to two NBFCs and one bank now with her CIBIL score, co-applicant ITRs and the offer timeline, so the sanction is quick once offers arrive. Do not pay any processing fee yet.

Budget for Phase 1: application fees €35–€55 each (₹4–6k each) unless waived · IELTS ≈ ₹18,000 · document fees ≈ ₹5–8k.

Phase 2 — Offers, deposits & GOI-IES (January – March 2027)

By	Action	Detail / tactic
Jan	**Receive offers** (conditional or unconditional)	Typical turnaround is 2–8 weeks. Record each offer's conditions, deposit amount and deadline, refund policy if the visa is refused, and the confirmed 2027/28 fee.
Jan	**Offer comparison**	Use the decision rule in Deliverable 1 §4.3: **Galway if any scholarship or ₹4 L+ extra support; otherwise UL; Dublin only with GOI-IES or ₹10 L+ extra.**
Late Jan (expected)	**GOI-IES 2027 call opens**	The 2026 call opened on 29 Jan 2026 *(official)*. The applicant **must already hold an offer**. The application covers academic record, a personal statement, reference(s) and a statement of how she will contribute to Ireland–India links.
Feb	**Pay one deposit only**	Usually €500–€1,500 (₹55k–₹1.65 L). Before paying, check (a) the **refund-on-visa-refusal** clause in writing and (b) that the deposit counts toward the €6,000 tuition minimum for the visa. Do not pay deposits at two universities.
Feb	Meet offer conditions	Upload the final IELTS score and any outstanding documents. Aim to turn a conditional offer into an **unconditional (final) offer** by mid-March, because the loan and visa both need it.
~12 Mar (expected; the 2026 deadline was **12 Mar 2026** *(official)*)	**Submit GOI-IES**	Results came out in early June in the 2026 cycle. Continue the full self-funded plan in parallel; never wait for this result.

By	Action	Detail / tactic
Mar	University accommodation	Apply on day one of the residence portal (Galway: Corrib Village / Goldcrest; UL: on-campus villages). Places are limited and often allocated early.

Phase 3 — Loan sanction & proof of funds (March – May 2027)

By	Action	Detail / tactic
15 Mar	**Formal loan applications** to 2–3 lenders	Submit the final offer letter, fee structure, IELTS, academic documents, CV, co-applicant KYC/ITRs/bank statements and collateral papers if needed.
10 Apr	**Compare written sanction letters**	Compare effective interest rate, processing fee, insurance add-ons, moratorium (course + 6–12 months), whether interest can be serviced during study, prepayment charges, and the **tuition vs living-cost disbursement split**. Get everything **in writing**.
20 Apr	Sign sanction; **disburse tuition**	The lender pays the university directly (wire to the university's Irish bank or via its approved payment portal). **Pay at least €6,000; ideally the full first-year fee.** Keep the **university's fee receipt**, which is mandatory for the visa.
Apr	TCS check	Confirm that the bank applies the **nil-TCS treatment for loan-financed education remittances**. Get a Form 15CA/CB or remittance certificate for the records.
May	**Build the living-cost evidence**	The visa needs **immediate access to at least €10,000 (≈₹11 L)**. Provide (a) the loan sanction letter showing the living-cost component, **and** (b) a bank statement in her or her sponsor's name showing ₹11 L+ in liquid funds. Keep the balance **stable for 6 months**: no unexplained large deposits before filing.
May	Sponsor pack (if parents contribute)	Sponsor's letter of support, ITRs for 3 years, 6-month bank statements, proof of relationship, and an affidavit of support.
May	Medical insurance	Buy an Irish-compliant private student health policy (≈€200–€550 a year) covering the full study period.

Phase 4 — Visa, accommodation & pre-departure (late May – July 2027)

Visa rule: an Irish Long Stay 'D' Study Visa application can be lodged **up to 3 months before travel**. Processing is **about 8 weeks** *(official guidance)* and longer in peak season. For a ~25 August arrival, submit **between 25 May and 15 June 2027**.

By	Action	Detail / tactic
25 May	Complete the **AVATS online application**	Long Stay 'D' — Study. The single-entry visa fee is €60, paid at VFS in INR, plus the VFS service charge.
25 May – 15 Jun	**VFS Global, Bengaluru**: biometrics and documents	Book the appointment early in the window.
—	**Visa document pack**	☐ Passport + old passports · ☐ AVATS summary signed · ☐ 2 photos · ☐ **Letter of acceptance** (unconditional) · ☐ **Fee-payment receipt** (≥ €6,000; ideally the full fee) · ☐ **Evidence of €10,000+ access** + loan sanction · ☐ 6-month bank statements · ☐ Sponsor pack (if any) · ☐ IELTS TRF · ☐ Degree certificates and transcripts · ☐ **Cover letter / study plan** (summarise the SOP's "why specialise after an MBA" and the commitment to comply with immigration conditions) · ☐ **Gap explanation** for Oct 2023 – Jul 2024 · ☐ Employment letters (Amazon, EY) · ☐ CV · ☐ Medical insurance · ☐ Fully translated/attested documents where required

By	Action	Detail / tactic
Jun	**Book accommodation**	Don't wait for the visa decision; choose a contract with a **visa-refusal cancellation clause**. Galway: Corrib Village, Goldcrest, Westside or Newcastle shared houses. Limerick: UL villages or Castletroy/Dooradoyle rentals. Use Daft.ie and the university's official housing portal **only**, and never send a deposit for a room you have not verified (rental scams are common).
Jun	Resign / notice planning	Work out the Amazon notice period and set a last working day around 31 July. Ask for the experience letter and relieving letter.
Jun	If the visa is refused	Ask for the refusal letter. An **appeal** is possible within **2 months**, so address each stated reason point by point. Check the university's fee-refund terms.
Jul	**Visa decision**, then book flights	Bengaluru → Dublin (Shannon for Limerick). Book once the visa is in the passport.
Jul	Forex	A forex card or international debit card with about €1,500 for the first month, plus the living-cost loan disbursement planned for September.

Phase 5 — Arrival & first 60 days (August – October 2027)

When	Action	Detail
~25 Aug	Fly to Ireland	Arrive 7–10 days before orientation. Carry originals of every visa document in hand luggage for border control.
Week 1	Open a bank account	AIB / Bank of Ireland / PTSB, using a university enrolment letter and proof of address. Revolut works as a bridge.
Week 1–2	**Register for the IRP** (Stamp 2)	Book through the immigration service as directed for the region (≈ €300). The IRP card is what allows her to work.
Week 2–4	**PPSN**	Apply once she has a job offer, through MyWelfare.ie.
Sept	Orientation and careers service	Register with the careers service in week 1. Big 4 and Tech EMEA **graduate programmes open in September–October and close early**, so apply in the first term.
Sept–Oct	Part-time job	10–15 hrs/week is a sensible cap for a 90-ECTS one-year programme. Aim for roles that add to the CV (finance or admin assistant, bookkeeping, university jobs) where possible.

Post-study milestones (for planning)

When	Milestone
Sept – Dec 2027	Apply for graduate and analyst roles for September 2028 starts (Big 4 tax/risk, Tech EMEA trust & safety and tax, insurers' operational risk)
Sept – Oct 2028	Results published → apply for **Stamp 1G** (Level 9: 12 + 12 months)
2028 – 2030	Secure a role ≥ **€40,904 (CSEP)** / **€36,848 (CSEP, recent graduate)** / **€36,605 (GEP)**; start the ACCA / CAI / CII professional pathway using exemptions
2028 – 2031	Loan repayment, 36–60 months base case, with prepayments

Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Galway prerequisite query (accounting modules)	Low	Upload the syllabus extract with the application

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
IELTS below 6.5 in one band	Medium	Book early; keep the December retake slot
2027/28 fees rise	High	4% contingency already in the model
No scholarship	High	The base plan never assumes one; UL stays fully viable
Loan sanction below ₹30 L	Medium	Apply to three lenders; UL needs the least
Accommodation shortage	High in Galway and Dublin	Apply for residences in March; private search from June; scam check
Visa delay	Medium	File in late May; complete pack; gap explanation included
Part-time job slow to materialise	Medium	Not part of the base plan; the 1-month cash buffer covers it